HISTORY

⏳ TIMELINES & DATING

READ Reading: How do historians know when things happened?

Historians study the past by examining evidence. One useful way to organise evidence is with a timeline. A timeline places events in chronological order — the order in which they happened. Timelines help historians see what happened before, after or at the same time as another event.

Dating events can be challenging because historians do not always know the exact year. Dates can be written in different ways. BCE means “Before Common Era” and CE means “Common Era”. These terms are often used instead of BC and AD. For example, 500 BCE happened before 100 BCE, while 500 CE happened after 100 CE.

Counting years before and after 1 CE works differently from a modern number line. When moving forward through BCE dates, the numbers become smaller: 800 BCE → 600 BCE → 400 BCE → 200 BCE → 1 BCE. After 1 BCE comes 1 CE; there is no year 0 in the traditional BCE/CE dating system.

Centuries are another way historians describe periods of time. The 1st century CE includes the years 1–100 CE. The 2nd century includes 101–200 CE. The 5th century BCE includes 500–401 BCE. This can seem confusing at first, so historians often use timelines to check the order of dates.

Approximate dates are sometimes used when an exact date is unknown. A historian might write c. 300 BCE, where “c.” means “circa”, or “about”. Other evidence may help historians estimate when an event occurred, such as written records, inscriptions, coins, buildings, artefacts and scientific dating methods.

1 Key terms

TERM	MEANING
chronological	arranged in the order events happened
BCE	Before Common Era
CE	Common Era
century	a period of 100 years
circa (c.)	about or approximately

2 Comprehension

a. What is a timeline?

_____

b. What does BCE mean?

_____

c. What does “c.” mean when used before a date?

_____

d. Why can dating events be challenging for historians?

_____

e. Name two types of evidence that can help historians work out when something happened.

_____

3 Put the dates in order

Write the dates from earliest to latest. Remember that BCE dates count backwards towards 1 BCE.

1. 300 BCE • 100 BCE • 500 BCE • 50 BCE

Answer: _____

2. 200 CE • 100 BCE • 50 CE • 400 BCE

Answer: _____

3. 700 BCE • 200 BCE • 100 CE • 900 BCE

Answer: _____

4 Read the timeline

EVENT	DATE
First Olympic Games held in ancient Greece (traditionally dated)	776 BCE
Roman Republic begins	509 BCE
Alexander the Great dies	323 BCE
Roman Empire begins	27 BCE
Pompeii is destroyed by volcanic eruption	79 CE
Western Roman Empire traditionally ends	476 CE

a. Which event happened first?

b. Which event happened last?

c. How many listed events happened before 1 CE?

d. Which event happened closest to 1 CE?

e. Put these three events in chronological order: Alexander the Great dies; Pompeii is destroyed; Roman Republic begins.

5 True or False

1. 600 BCE happened before 300 BCE. True / False

2. 200 CE happened before 100 CE. True / False

3. The 5th century CE includes the year 450 CE. True / False

4. The 5th century BCE includes the year 450 BCE. True / False

5. There is a year 0 between 1 BCE and 1 CE. True / False

6 Reading between the lines

a. Why would a historian use a timeline when studying a long period of history?

b. Why might an approximate date such as c. 300 BCE be useful?

c. Why can BCE dates be confusing for students who are used to modern number lines?

7 Century detective

a. Which century is 250 CE in? _____

b. Which century is 476 CE in? _____

c. Which century is 450 BCE in? _____

d. Which century is 776 BCE in? _____

e. Is 101 CE in the 1st or 2nd century? _____

8 Challenge: Build a timeline

Place these events in chronological order on the timeline below. Then label each date as BCE or CE.

☐ first Olympic Games — 776 BCE

☐ Roman Republic begins — 509 BCE

☐ Alexander the Great dies — 323 BCE

☐ Pompeii destroyed — 79 CE

☐ Western Roman Empire ends — 476 CE

← EARLIER **LATER →**

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9 Extended response

Explain why timelines and accurate dating are important to historians. Use at least three key terms from this worksheet. Aim for 100–120 words.

🏺 YEAR 7 HISTORY — ARCHAEOLOGY

Comprehension & Historical Thinking

📖 Read: What Is Archaeology?

Archaeology is the study of people in the past through the objects, buildings and other evidence they left behind. Archaeologists investigate places called archaeological sites. These may include ancient towns, camps, graves, shipwrecks or places where people made tools. They carefully excavate soil layer by layer because the position of an object can provide important clues about when and how it was used.

Archaeologists find many different kinds of artefacts. An artefact is an object made or changed by people, such as a pot, coin, tool, bead or piece of jewellery. They also study ecofacts, such as animal bones, seeds and pollen, which can tell us about food, farming and the environment. Features such as hearths, walls, post holes and floors are also evidence, even though they cannot always be moved.

Archaeologists do not simply collect interesting objects. They record where evidence is found, measure and photograph it, and compare it with other evidence. Scientific methods can also help. For example, radiocarbon dating can estimate the age of some organic materials. By combining different types of evidence, archaeologists can build explanations about how people lived, worked, travelled and interacted in the past.

🔎 Key Vocabulary

Term	Meaning
archaeology	study of the human past using physical evidence
artefact	an object made or changed by people
ecofact	natural remains that provide evidence about past people and environments
excavate	to carefully dig and uncover evidence
site	a place where archaeological evidence is found
radiocarbon dating	a scientific method used to estimate the age of some organic materials

1. Find the Information

1. What is archaeology?

_____
_____

2. Give TWO examples of archaeological sites.

_____

3. Why do archaeologists excavate soil layer by layer?

_____
_____

4. What is an artefact? Give one example.

_____
_____

5. What is an ecofact? Give one example.

_____
_____

6. Name TWO features that archaeologists may study.

_____
_____

2. True, False or Not Stated

☐ True ☐ False ☐ Not stated — Archaeologists study only objects made from stone.

☐ True ☐ False ☐ Not stated — The location of an object can provide clues about the past.

☐ True ☐ False ☐ Not stated — Animal bones can provide information about food.

☐ True ☐ False ☐ Not stated — Every archaeological site is an ancient city.

☐ True ☐ False ☐ Not stated — Archaeologists use more than one type of evidence.

3. Reading Between the Lines

7. Why would an archaeologist photograph and measure an artefact instead of simply taking it away?

_____
_____

8. What could a collection of seeds found at a site tell archaeologists?

_____
_____

9. Why is it useful to compare evidence from several sources?

_____
_____

10. The passage says archaeology helps us understand how people 'lived, worked, travelled and interacted'. What does this suggest about archaeology?

_____
_____

4. Evidence Detective 🕵️

Imagine archaeologists discover the following evidence at a site. Decide what each piece of evidence might help them learn.

Evidence found	What might it tell us?	Artefact / Ecofact / Feature?
A clay cooking pot		
Animal bones		
A stone hearth		
Wheat seeds		
A bronze coin		

5. Vocabulary in Context

Choose the best word from the box: artefact excavate site ecofact evidence

11. The archaeologists carefully _____ the ground around the buried wall.

12. A coin found at the _____ helped researchers learn about trade.

13. The animal bone was an _____ because it was natural material from the past.

14. The pottery bowl was an _____ made by people.

15. The objects, bones and buildings all provided _____ about the past.

6. Extended Response — Archaeology Matters

Write 6–8 sentences explaining why archaeology is important for historians. Use at least FOUR of these words: evidence, artefact, ecofact, site, excavate, dating.

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

ANCIENT EGYPT: MUMMIFICATION

Comprehension & Historical Thinking

📖 Read: Why Did Ancient Egyptians Mummify the Dead?

Ancient Egyptians believed that life continued after death. They thought a person needed their body to remain recognisable so that the spirit could live in the afterlife. Because of this belief, some Egyptians prepared bodies through a process called mummification. The process was especially important for wealthy and powerful people, although practices varied depending on a person's wealth and status.

Mummification was a careful process. First, the body was washed. The brain was usually removed through the nose. The internal organs were removed and treated so they would not decay quickly. The heart was generally left inside the body because Egyptians believed it was important to a person's identity and judgement in the afterlife. The body was then dried using natron, a naturally occurring salt mixture. Drying was important because moisture encourages decay.

After the body had been dried, it was treated with oils and resins. The body was wrapped in many layers of linen. Amulets were often placed among the wrappings to provide protection. The wrapped body became a mummy. It could then be placed in a coffin or series of coffins and taken to a tomb, where food, objects and other goods might be provided for the person's journey into the afterlife.

Mummification gives historians evidence about ancient Egyptian beliefs, technology and daily life. Archaeologists can study mummies, coffins, tombs, tools and written records to learn about the past. However, historians must remember that burial practices were not identical for everyone. They changed over thousands of years and were influenced by a person's wealth, status and the period in which they lived.

🔎 Key Vocabulary

Word	Meaning
mummification	the process of preserving a dead body
mummy	a preserved body
natron	a naturally occurring salt mixture used to dry the body
linen	a cloth made from flax, used for wrapping the body
amulet	a small object believed to provide protection
afterlife	the life believed to continue after death
tomb	a place where a dead person was buried

1. Find the Information

1. Why did some ancient Egyptians believe the body needed to remain recognisable?

_____

_____

2. What was natron used for?

_____

_____

3. What happened to the brain during mummification?

_____

_____

4. Why was the heart generally left inside the body?

_____

_____

5. What was the body wrapped in?

_____

_____

6. Name TWO things that might be placed in a tomb.

_____

_____

2. True, False or Not Stated

☐ True ☐ False ☐ Not stated — Ancient Egyptians believed some form of life continued after death.

Reason: _____

☐ True ☐ False ☐ Not stated — Natron was used to keep the body wet.

Reason: _____

☐ True ☐ False ☐ Not stated — The heart was generally kept inside the body.

Reason: _____

☐ True ☐ False ☐ Not stated — Every ancient Egyptian was mummified in exactly the same way.

Reason: _____

☐ True ☐ False ☐ Not stated — Amulets could be included among the linen wrappings.

Reason: _____

3. Put the Process in Order

_____ The body was wrapped in linen.

_____ The body was washed.

_____ The body was dried using natron.

_____ The body was placed in a coffin or tomb.

_____ The organs were removed and treated.

_____ Oils and resins were applied.

4. Evidence Detective

Historians use different sources to investigate the past. Complete the table by explaining what each source might help a historian learn.

Historical Source	What could it tell us?	Primary or Secondary?
Mummy		
Coffin with painted images		
Amulet		
Written description from ancient Egypt		
Modern history textbook		

6. Vocabulary in Context

Choose from: mummification natron amulet linen afterlife tomb

11. The Egyptians used _____ to dry the body.

12. The body was wrapped in strips of _____.

13. An _____ could be placed with the mummy for protection.

14. A place where a dead person was buried was called a _____.

15. The belief that existence continued after death is called the _____.

16. The process of preserving a dead body is called _____.

7. Extended Response ✍️

Explain why mummification was important in ancient Egyptian society. In your response, refer to religious beliefs, the mummification process and what historians can learn from archaeological evidence. Write 6-8 sentences.

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

THE FEUDAL SYSTEM

Comprehension & Historical Thinking

📖 Read: How Did the Feudal System Work?

In medieval Europe, society was organised in a system often called feudalism. The exact system varied from place to place and changed over time, but it was generally based on land, loyalty and service. After the Norman Conquest of England in 1066, a feudal system developed in England in which the king granted land to powerful nobles in return for loyalty and military support.

The king was at the top of the social and political hierarchy. He was considered the owner of all the land, although he granted large areas to nobles, also called lords. In return, nobles promised loyalty and provided soldiers when the king needed an army. Some nobles gave parts of their land to knights. Knights served their lord and could be expected to fight for him. They also had responsibilities to protect people and maintain order on their lands.

Most people were peasants who lived and worked on the land. Some were free peasants, while others were serfs. Serfs were not slaves, but they were legally tied to the land they worked on. They had to provide labour, crops or other payments to their lord. In return, they generally received protection and access to land on which they could grow food.

Manors were important centres of medieval life. A manor might include a lord's house, peasant homes, fields, a church, woodland and a mill. Much of what people needed was produced locally. The feudal system created a network of obligations: the king depended on nobles, nobles depended on knights and peasants, and peasants depended on the manor for land and protection. However, life was unequal, and people at different levels had very different rights, wealth and opportunities.

🔎 Key Vocabulary

Term	Meaning
feudalism	a medieval system based on land, loyalty and service
monarch	a king or queen
noble / lord	a powerful landholder who received land from the king
knight	a trained warrior who served a lord
peasant	a person who worked the land, usually for a living
serf	a peasant legally tied to the land they worked on
manor	a large estate where a lord and local community lived and worked
obligation	a duty or responsibility that someone is expected to fulfil

1. Find the Information

1. What three ideas was the feudal system generally based on?

_____
_____

2. What happened after the Norman Conquest of England in 1066?

_____
_____

3. What did nobles promise the king in return for land?

_____
_____

4. What responsibilities did knights have?

_____
_____

5. What is a serf?

_____
_____

6. What was a manor?

_____
_____

2. Understanding the Hierarchy

Complete the hierarchy from highest to lowest. Then explain how each level was connected.

1. _____	Main role / responsibility: _____
2. _____	Main role / responsibility: _____
3. _____	Main role / responsibility: _____
4. _____	Main role / responsibility: _____
5. _____	Main role / responsibility: _____

How did the people at these levels depend on one another?

_____
_____
_____
_____

3. True, False or Not Stated

☐ True ☐ False ☐ Not stated — The feudal system was exactly the same everywhere in medieval Europe.

Evidence from the passage: _____

☐ True ☐ False ☐ Not stated — Nobles could provide soldiers for the king.

Evidence from the passage: _____

☐ True ☐ False ☐ Not stated — Knights were trained warriors who served lords.

Evidence from the passage: _____

☐ True ☐ False ☐ Not stated — Serfs were slaves who could be bought and sold.

Evidence from the passage: _____

☐ True ☐ False ☐ Not stated — A manor could contain fields, homes and a mill.

Evidence from the passage: _____

4. Reading Between the Lines

7. Why would a king want powerful nobles to promise loyalty and military support?

_____
_____

8. Why might peasants have depended on a manor?

_____
_____

9. What does the feudal system tell us about inequality in medieval society?

_____
_____

10. Why might historians say the feudal system was a network of relationships rather than just a social pyramid?

_____
_____

5. Vocabulary in Context

Choose from: feudalism manor noble knight peasant serf obligation

11. A _____ was a powerful landholder who received land from the king.

12. A trained warrior who served a lord was a _____.

13. A medieval estate where a lord and community lived and worked was a _____.

14. A _____ was legally tied to the land they worked on.

15. The system based on land, loyalty and service is called _____.

16. A duty or responsibility is an _____.

6. Compare Two People

Imagine a knight and a serf living on the same manor. Complete the table.

Question	Knight	Serf
What work might they do?		
What might they owe to someone else?		
What protection or benefits might they receive?		
How much power might they have?		

7. Extended Response ✍️

Explain how the feudal system worked in medieval England. In your response, discuss the roles of the king, nobles, knights and peasants/serfs. Explain how land, loyalty and service connected them. Write 8–10 sentences.

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____